

lid to do everything you will need it for. (My used one didn't have the drip pan, and I did fine—but I don't plan on cooking meat in it.)

4. The chopper / processor

Most of the time, I use the world's oldest food chopper (i.e., my knife). There are times where I really do go crazy with my tiny food processor, however. These are instances where a knife just wouldn't cut it, and it is worth the time cleaning components to get a good consistent chop going.

Making baby food. There's really no need to buy baby food if you have access to fresh or high-quality fruits, veggies, rice, and meat. A food chopper can get it to the right consistency in no time (and adding water can make it smoother). For excellent baby food tips, see the baby food preparation resources at Dr. Sears' website (AskDrSears.com).

Freezing for later. Looking to use up all of those tomatoes from your garden? How about whipping up some salsa, pasta sauce, or bruschetta topping? The food chopper can save so much time, and you'll be proud of all of the produce you can use up and eat later in the year.

Purchase Tip: This is a product that I prefer to buy small. Since I'm not mass-producing much these days,

I have found satisfaction with a cheap, off-brand food processor from the same Black Friday deals that I get my mini slow-cookers from. Mine has lasted over four years, but if you want something bigger or name-brand, look for one with as few components as necessary. (Remember, you'll be taking it apart and cleaning it after each use!) — **Linsey Knerl**



7 Ways to Save Big Money with Ice Cube Trays

With all the new refrigerators coming with ice makers these days, ice cube trays can regularly be found at yard sales and thrift stores for quite literally, a dime a dozen. What does this mean for you? Big money, that's what!